

*Army Vantage**Palantir Foundry-based)*

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Overview

Army Vantage (Palantir Foundry-based)

1. Vantage Basics

- Open database / source data — You don't "open" a traditional database. Instead:
 - Data is ingested via Data Connection (automated pipelines from authoritative Army systems).
 - You explore data through the Ontology (real-world objects like Units, Soldiers, Equipment) or Object Explorer / Force Explorer.
 - Use Contour for no-code / low-code analysis on large datasets.
- Run a query —
 - Point-and-click in Contour, or use Fusion (spreadsheet-like).
 - For advanced users: write code in Python/R or use built-in query tools.
- Export to file — Easy export to CSV, Excel, etc., from any view, table, or report.

2. Automation & Power Automate / Office 365

- Vantage has strong native automation via Pipelines and scheduled Data Connections.
- Direct Power Automate integration is limited, but you can trigger actions via APIs or export data that Power Automate can pick up.
- Strong Microsoft 365 ties overall (see below).

3. Create & Share Dashboards

- Use Workshop → point-and-click app/dashboard builder. Embed charts, object sets, tables, maps, etc.
- Use Reports for polished, document-style outputs with embedded visuals.
- Sharing is role-based and very secure (common in DoD environments).
- Yes — user management can integrate with MS Entra ID / Office 365 Active Directory (especially in Army environments). Many units use this for authentication.

4. Use with Power BI Desktop

- Direct connector exists — Palantir provides an official Power BI Connector (ODBC + Power Query) and a REST-based option.
- You can connect directly to Foundry datasets/objects and pull live or refreshed data into Power BI.
- Automation for PBI modeling —
 - Use scheduled pipelines in Vantage to prepare data.
 - Power BI Gateway + Foundry connector for automated refreshes in the Power BI Service.

- Expanded Vantage-to-Power BI connector is widely used in the Army (hundreds of thousands of connections per month).
- Report builder — Vantage has its own strong report/dashboard tools (Workshop + Reports). Many users build final products in Vantage Workshop and/or export to Power BI depending on audience needs. They complement each other rather than compete.

Quick Start Tip: Most Army users begin in Contour or Object Explorer for exploration, then move to Workshop for dashboards or export to Power BI for broader distribution.

Quick user manual

📖 Army Vantage – Basic Steps

1) Open the Platform

1. Navigate to:
👉 <https://vantage.army.mil>
2. Log in with CAC (Army network required)
3. Use the **left navigation panel** to access tools (Projects, Data, Reports, etc.)
[\[financialf...e.army.mil\]](#)

2) Open a Query / Analysis Tool

You don't typically open a "SQL editor" like a database — instead you use:

👉 **Contour (analysis tool)** or **Workshop (apps)**

- From left menu → select **Contour** (point-and-click analysis) [\[financialf...e.army.mil\]](#)

3) Run a Basic "Query"

(Vantage is mostly no-code, but conceptually this is your query step)

Example A – View dataset (like "SELECT *")

1. Open **Contour**
2. Select a dataset / Object (e.g., Units, Personnel, Logistics)
3. Apply filters or choose columns

✅ This = your "basic query result table"

Example B – Filter data (pseudo-query)

Use filters like:

Unit = "XYZ"

Status = "Active"

Date > Last 30 days

- ✓ This behaves like a SQL `WHERE` clause
-

4) View Data Sources / Available Data

1. Go to **Object / Force Explorer**
2. Browse:
 - Objects (datasets)
 - Properties (columns)
3. Explore relationships between datasets [\[financialf...e.army.mil\]](#)

- ✓ This = your "list databases/tables"
-

5) Export Data

1. From a table or report:
 - Click **Export / Download**
2. Choose format:
 - CSV
 - Excel

- ✓ Data is downloaded locally or shared within Vantage
-

6) Create & Share Report / Dashboard

1. Go to **Reports**
2. Add:
 - tables
 - charts
3. Save report
4. Share with users or groups

- ✓ Reports = your "dashboard layer" [\[financialf...e.army.mil\]](#)
-

⚠ Important Differences (vs SQL tools)

- No direct "run `SELECT version()`" command
- No standard SQL console exposed to most users
- Everything is:
 - object-based
 - filter-driven
 - UI + low-code

 Quick Translation (SQL → Vantage)

SQL action	Vantage equivalent
<code>SELECT * FROM table</code>	Open object in Contour
WHERE clause	Filters
<code>SHOW DATABASES</code>	Object Explorer
Export query results	Export button
BI dashboard	Reports

 One-Line Workflow

Login → Open Contour → Select dataset → Apply filters → View results → Export or build report

Power BI + Vantage step-by-step

✓ 0) What this setup uses

- Palantir Vantage (data platform)
- Power BI Desktop
- Foundry / Vantage connector (behind the scenes)

👉 There is an official **Power BI connector for Palantir Foundry** (what Vantage runs on)
[\[learn.microsoft.com\]](https://learn.microsoft.com)

🕒 1) Prepare Data in Vantage

1. Log into Vantage → <https://vantage.army.mil>
2. Navigate to:
 - **Contour** (analysis) OR
 - **Ontology / Objects**
3. Build your dataset:
 - Select object (dataset)
 - Apply filters
 - Choose fields/columns
4. Save it as:
 - **Data Product** OR
 - Saved dataset/report

✓ This is your "Power BI data source"

🔌 2) Connect Power BI Desktop

In Power BI Desktop:

1. Go to **Home** → **Get Data**
2. Search for: 👉 **Palantir Foundry**
3. Enter:
 - Base URL (your Vantage / Foundry instance)
 - Dataset ID (if required)
4. Choose:
 - **Import** (best for modeling)
 - OR **DirectQuery** (live connection) [\[learn.microsoft.com\]](https://learn.microsoft.com)
5. Sign in:
 - Organizational account (CAC-backed / OAuth)

- ✓ This establishes the connection
-

3) Select & Load Data

1. In Navigator:
 - Browse available datasets
2. Select your dataset(s)
3. Click:
 - **Load** → quick start
 - OR **Transform Data** → Power Query

- ✓ Data now in Power BI model
-

4) Build Your Model (Power BI)

1. Define:
 - relationships
 - measures (DAX)
2. Create visuals:
 - tables
 - charts
 - KPIs

- ✓ This is your reporting layer
-

5) Automate Refresh

Option A — Import Mode

1. Publish to Power BI Service
 2. Configure:
 - Scheduled refresh
 - Gateway (if needed)
-

Option B — DirectQuery

- No scheduled refresh required
- Data stays live in Vantage

- ✓ Used for near-real-time scenarios
-

6) Share Reports

1. Publish to:
 - Power BI Workspace
2. Share:
 - dashboard
 - app
 - report links

- ✓ Works with M365 permissions
-

7) Authentication & Access

- Uses:
 - OAuth / Organizational login [\[learn.microsoft.com\]](https://learn.microsoft.com)
 - Controlled by:
 - Vantage permissions
 - Power BI workspace roles
-

Important Notes (from real usage)

Integration Strength

- Army environments actively use this combo:
 - **Vantage + Power BI interoperability is common and high-volume**
[\[engineering.fyi\]](https://engineering.fyi)
-

Data Flow Pattern

1. Vantage (data pipelines + objects)
2. ↓
3. Saved dataset / data product
4. ↓
5. Power BI (Import or DirectQuery)
6. ↓
7. Dashboards / Apps
8. ``

9.

What runs where?

Function	Tool
Data prep / pipelines	Vantage
Data storage / logic	Vantage
Advanced modeling (DAX)	Power BI
Visualization	Power BI

Quick “Do This First” Checklist

1. ☒ Build dataset in Vantage (Contour)
2. ☒ Save as reusable dataset
3. ☒ Connect via Power BI → Foundry connector
4. ☒ Load + model
5. ☒ Publish + schedule refresh

Vantage → Power BI refresh → SharePoint export → Teams alert

End-to-End Flow (High-Level)

1. Vantage dataset updated
 2. ↓
 3. Power BI dataset refresh
 4. ↓
 5. Export / snapshot to SharePoint
 6. ↓
 7. Teams notification (with link)
-

OPTION A (Best Practice): Trigger from Power BI

Flow Name:

"Vantage Dataset Refresh → Notify & Publish"

1) Trigger: Power BI Dataset Refresh Complete

In Power Automate:

- Trigger:  **Power BI – When a dataset refresh completes**
 - Configure:
 - Workspace
 - Dataset (connected to Vantage)
-

2) Condition: Check Success

Add a condition:

Status = "Completed"

If failed → send failure alert (optional)

 3) Export Report Snapshot

Option 1 (Native)

- Action:  **Power BI – Export to File for Report**
- Format:
 - PDF (best for distribution)
 - PPTX (if needed)

Option 2 (Data-level export)

- Use:
 - Power BI REST API
 - OR Paginated Reports (if available)

 4) Save to SharePoint

- Action:  **SharePoint – Create File**
- Location:
 - Document Library (e.g., /Shared Reports/Vantage/)
- File naming pattern:

Vantage_Report_@{utcNow('yyyy-MM-dd_HH:mm')}.pdf

 5) Post to Teams

- Action:  **Microsoft Teams – Post message in channel**

Example message:

 Vantage dataset refresh completed

 Report updated: [SharePoint link]

 Time: @{utcNow()}

Dataset: Logistics Overview

OPTION B: Add Data Export Layer (CSV / Table)

If you want **raw data export (more like your earlier pattern)**:

 Insert Step After Refresh

Use:

 **Run a query against a dataset (Power BI)**

- DAX Query Example:

DAX

EVALUATE 'LogisticsTable'

 Convert to File

- Action:  Create CSV table
-

 Save to SharePoint

Same step as above:

- Output:

Vantage_Data_YYYYMMDD.csv

OPTION C: Fully Automated (Scheduled Pull)

If Vantage updates aren't event-driven:

Trigger:

 **Recurrence (e.g., every hour)**

Then:

1. Trigger Power BI dataset refresh
2. Wait (delay 2–5 min)
3. Continue export + Teams steps

Permissions Model (Important)

Layer	Controlled by
Vantage data	Palantir access
Power BI dataset	Workspace roles
SharePoint	Site permissions
Teams	Channel membership

Real-World Pattern (What most teams do)

“Gold Standard Flow”

Vantage (pipeline builds dataset)

↓

Power BI (semantic model)

↓

Power Automate:

- refresh dataset
 - export report
 - save snapshot to SharePoint
 - notify Teams
-

Pro Tips (from experience)

 Use folders like:

/Shared Documents/Vantage/

/Reports/

/Data Extracts/

✓ Add version tracking

- Include timestamp in file name
- OR overwrite "latest" + keep archive

✓ Add deep link back to Power BI

Include in Teams message:

🔗 Live dashboard: <https://app.powerbi.com/...>

✓ Failure branch

Add parallel condition:

- If refresh fails → Teams alert:

✗ Vantage dataset refresh FAILED

⚡ Minimal Version (if you want super lean)

Trigger: Dataset refresh complete

→ Export report (PDF)

→ Save to SharePoint

→ Post Teams message

1) Power Automate JSON Template (Basic)

 Note: This is a **minimal working template** you can import and then update connections/IDs.

JSON

```
{
  "definition": {
    "$schema": "https://schema.management.azure.com/providers/Microsoft.Logic/schemas/2019-05-01/workflowdefinition.json#",
    "actions": {
      "Export_Report": {
        "type": "ApiConnection",
        "inputs": {
          "host": {
            "connection": {
              "name": "@parameters('$connections')['powerbi']['connectionId']"
            }
          },
          "method": "post",
          "path":
            "/v1.0/myorg/groups/@{encodeURIComponent('WORKSPACE_ID')}/reports/@{encodeURIComponent('REPORT_ID')}/ExportTo",
          "body": {
            "format": "PDF"
          }
        },
      },
    },
  },
}
```

```
"Create_File_in_SharePoint": {  
  "runAfter": {  
    "Export_Report": [  
      "Succeeded"  
    ]  
  },  
  "type": "ApiConnection",  
  "inputs": {  
    "host": {  
      "connection": {  
        "name": "@parameters('$connections')['sharepointonline']['connectionId']"  
      }  
    },  
    "method": "post",  
    "path": "/datasets/default/files",  
    "body": {  
      "folderPath": "/Shared Documents/Vantage/Reports",  
      "name": "Vantage_Report_@{utcNow('yyyy-MM-dd_HH:mm')}.pdf",  
      "fileContent": "@body('Export_Report')"  
    }  
  }  
},  
  "Post_Teams_Message": {  
    "runAfter": {  
      "Create_File_in_SharePoint": [  
        "Succeeded"  
      ]  
    },  
  },  
}
```

```
"type": "ApiConnection",
"inputs": {
"host": {
"connection": {
"name": "@parameters('$connections')['teams']['connectionId']"
}
},
"method": "post",
"path": "/v3/conversations/CHANNEL_ID/messages",
"body": {
"content": "✅ Vantage dataset refresh completed\r\n📊 Report saved to SharePoint\r\n🕒 Time: @utcNow()}"
}
}
},
"triggers": {
"When_dataset_refresh_completes": {
"type": "ApiConnectionWebhook",
"inputs": {
"host": {
"connection": {
"name": "@parameters('$connections')['powerbi']['connectionId']"
}
},
"path": "/datasets/onrefreshcomplete",
"method": "get"
}
}
```

```
}  
  
}  
  
,  
  
"parameters": {  
"$connections": {  
  "value": {  
    "powerbi": {  
      "connectionId": "/providers/Microsoft.PowerApps/apis/shared_powerbi",  
      "connectionName": "shared_powerbi",  
      "id": "/providers/Microsoft.PowerApps/apis/shared_powerbi"  
    },  
    "sharepointonline": {  
      "connectionId": "/providers/Microsoft.PowerApps/apis/shared_sharepointonline",  
      "connectionName": "shared_sharepointonline",  
      "id": "/providers/Microsoft.PowerApps/apis/shared_sharepointonline"  
    },  
    "teams": {  
      "connectionId": "/providers/Microsoft.PowerApps/apis/shared_teams",  
      "connectionName": "shared_teams",  
      "id": "/providers/Microsoft.PowerApps/apis/shared_teams"  
    }  
  }  
}  
}  
}  
}  
}
```

 2) What You MUST Customize

Before it works, replace these values:

Field	Replace With
WORKSPACE_ID	Power BI workspace ID
REPORT_ID	Power BI report ID
CHANNEL_ID	Teams channel ID
SharePoint path	Your document library path

 3) Import Steps (Power Automate) Method 1 (Recommended – Solutions Import)

1. Go to:  <https://make.powerautomate.com>
2. Click: **Solutions** → **Import solution**
3. Upload your .zip (wrap JSON in a solution if needed)
4. Map connections:
 - Power BI
 - SharePoint
 - Teams
5. Click **Import**

 Method 2 (Quick Manual Setup)

Since raw JSON import is limited in UI:

1. Go to **My Flows**
2. Click **New** → **Automated cloud flow**
3. Recreate using:
 - Trigger: **Power BI – When a dataset refresh completes**
 - Add actions in same order:
 1. Export report
 2. Create SharePoint file
 3. Post Teams message

 Then use JSON above as reference for fields

4) Test the Flow

1. Trigger a dataset refresh in Power BI
2. Wait for completion
3. Verify:
 -  PDF in SharePoint
 -  Teams message posted

Optional Add-On (Highly Recommended)

Add a success/failure check

Insert condition:

Status = Completed

If FAILED:

Post Teams alert:

 Vantage dataset refresh FAILED

Final “Minimal Working Flow”

Trigger: Dataset refresh complete

→ Export report (PDF)

→ Save to SharePoint

→ Post Teams message

Reference

1. [Army Vantage](#)

2. [Palantir Foundry Power Query connector - Power Query | Microsoft Learn](#)